

MISSION SUDARSHAN CHAKRA: India's Integrated Defence Shield

What happens when AI, missile defence, cyber warfare, and national security merge into one integrated shield? Mission Sudarshan Chakra offers a glimpse.



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The views expressed in this article are solely those of the author. Any comments regarding India's defence capabilities or perceived shortcomings reflect the author's personal analysis.

Operation Sindoor succeeded in neutralising the designated terror targets without collateral damage. However, the operation exposed capability gaps and vulnerabilities. Enemy drones were able to penetrate Indian airspace, though in limited numbers, to strike border civilian areas, revealing shortcomings in low-altitude air defence, counter-drone measures, and rapid point protection systems.

Lack of coordination across radar networks and communication systems prevented the consistent, seamless integration of air, space, cyber, and electronic warfare assets. Several advanced sensors and weapon systems, despite being effective independently, failed to integrate fully into a unified real-time defence grid.

Fault lines observed included inadequate electronic warfare capability, limited cyber and drone warfare capacity, insufficient counter-unmanned systems, the unavailability of military-grade drones capable of surviving in GPS-denied and contested environments, siloed systems, service-specific processes, and limited

ability to adapt quickly to changing operational needs.

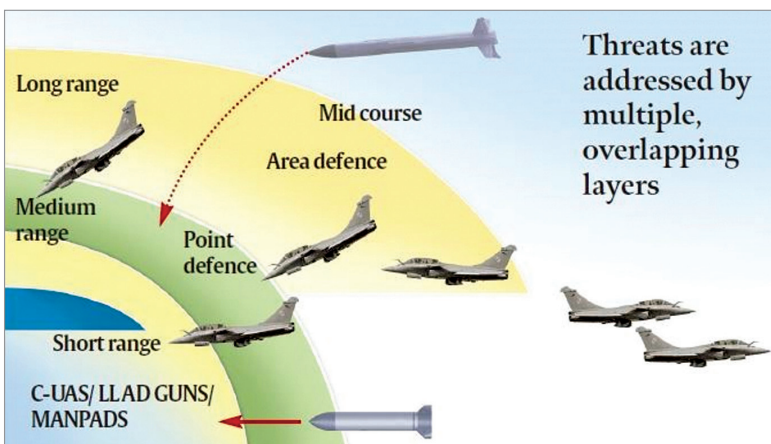
The gaps revealed underscore the urgency of building a self-reliant, scalable, next-generation, multi-layered air and missile defence network. This strategic imperative set the stage for Mission Sudarshan Chakra, conceptualised with inspiration drawn from the mythological Sudarshan Chakra wielded by Lord Krishna, the epic symbol of a divine, multi-layered weapon that struck with precision and always returned to its wielder, embodying resilience, control, and protection against threats.

Mission Sudarshan Chakra envisions a nationwide, integrated shield capable of detecting, tracking, and neutralising threats across air, cyber, and electronic domains. Just as the mythological weapon combined speed, accuracy, and adaptability, the mission seeks to create a self-reliant, layered system-of-systems capable of responding swiftly and decisively to emerging challenges.

Designing the Sudarshan Chakra

The Sudarshan Chakra, conceived as a next-generation air and missile defence network, is structured as a modular and scalable framework. The architecture forms a multi-layered national grid that integrates detection, tracking, threat evaluation, and neutralisation across air, cyber, and electronic warfare domains.

The design ensures interoperability, integration of indigenous technology, and resilience in contested or degraded operational environments. The framework includes rapid counterattack capability against threats such as terrorist training camps, unmanned aerial systems (UAS), missile storage and launch sites, and command-and-control centres.



Multilayered counter-drone and air defence grid (Source: www.shankariasparliament.com)